26.2 Adding log messages to your application

In this section we'll look in detail at how to create log messages in your own application. You'll learn how to create an instance of `ILogger`, and how to use it to add logging to an existing application. Finally, we'll look at the properties that make up a logging record, what they mean, and what you can use them for.

Logging, like almost everything in ASP.NET Core, is available through DI. To add logging to your own services, you need only inject an instance of `ILogger<T>`, where `T` is the type of your service.

NOTE When you inject `ILogger<T>`, the DI container indirectly calls `ILoggerFactory.CreateLogger<T>()` to create the wrapped `ILogger` of figure 26.3. In section 26.2.2 you'll see how to work directly with `ILoggerFactory` if you prefer. The `ILogger<T>` interface also implements the nongeneric `ILogger` interface but includes additional convenience methods.

You can use the injected `ILogger` instance to create log messages, which it writes to each configured `ILoggerProvider`. The following listing shows how to inject an `ILogger<>` instance into the `PageModel` of the Index.cshtml Razor Page for the recipe application from previous chapters and how to write a log message indicating how many recipes were found.

Listing 26.2 Injecting `ILogger` into a class and writing a log message